

# DRAWDOWN DIPTYCHS

This project will research & examine a topic related to climate change through the exploration of public domain visual resources.

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Visual research and intuitive making will lead to formal experiment, meaning making, and poster design.

- To start, please go through Project Drawdown's Solutions and find something that interests you. [[<https://www.drawdown.org/solutions>]]
- Conduct research on-line to help inform this project. Dig into whichever solution you choose from Project DrawDown — what else can you learn? what is there to draw design ideas from?
- Collecting reusable graphics from the provided free-use sources that you somehow decide relate. What signs, symbols, images, etc. allow for metaphor and new meaning to be uncovered?
- You may free-associate and/or stray somewhat from your original subject as the project evolves.
- The goal is to reconsider our relationship to a thing or experience that perhaps seemed familiar in one context, and explore its application to design and culture in a new context.

## PART 1

(WK1 & WK2)

An experimental, expressive graphic exploration that responds to the source material: Drawdown.org

- Slideshow with bibliography
- 20 experimental compositions, explore type only, image only and type and image combined

## READINGS

- Project Drawdown (DrawDown.org)
- Additional (optional? extra?) useful readings in **DrawdownDiptych.pdf**

## PART 2

(WK3 & WK4 & WK5)

Two posters that create a dialogue about your topic and that challenge your audience to think critically.

- 2 printed or animated posters, sized to your discretion.
- Each poster must use:
  - a grid
  - 3 levels of hierarchy including a heading
  - 200 words of text
  - at least one image.

What all of this means of course is up to you: the size, grid, etc. should all make sense based on your approach... how can you "make meaning" through selecting these design elements – not just through your text/ image choices?

## SCHEDULE

MAR 30 | Project Assigned!

Step 1: Reading, Research, and Collection (DUE APRIL 6)

APRIL 6 | Review Step 1 Reading, Research and Collection PDFs.

Step 2: Formal Experimentation (DUE APRIL 13)

APRIL 13 | Review Step 2 Formal Experimentation compositions

Step 3: Start Diptychs

APRIL 20 | Continue work on posters

APRIL 27 | Critique: "Posters" due.

## RESOURCES

### Image Gathering Links:

[Flickr.com/Commons](https://www.flickr.com/commons)  
[etc.usf.edu/clipart](https://etc.usf.edu/clipart)  
[RawPixel.com/category/53/public-domain](https://RawPixel.com/category/53/public-domain)

### Poster Designer Inspiration:

Anette Lenz  
Art Sims  
Bráulio Amado  
Daniel Eatock  
Emory Douglas  
Jean Benoit Levy  
Philippe Apeloig  
Shun Ishizuka  
Sindiso Nyoni  
Skolos and Wedell  
Vincent Perrottet  
Yve Ludwig

WK1: ASSIGNED MAR 30; FOR REVIEW APRIL 6

## Research & Collection

Collect ideas and references from the reading; Collect visuals from recommended sources; Collect other information as needed.

// Deliverables: slideshow with bibliography of sources

### 1. Read Through Project Drawdown's table of solutions.

- Choose a solution that interests you.
  - Skim across the solutions, and once you pick one that interests you, please read your chosen section carefully.
  - What else can you then go and find about this solution?
    - where is it done? who is doing it? is this pragmatic today? what new opportunities does this create? what changes in society/culture are required? what new thinking is necessary? what does this extend or enhance? what else does this amputate or deprecate?

### 2. Create a free association content mapping study:

- Make a list of 10+ key words that describe your solution, or that you find otherwise important or related.
- Find 3 aphorisms or quotes that describe something about the solution beyond what's on Project Drawdown's site.
- Look at free/libre/opensource/creative commons/public domain resources and collect images, illustrations, diagrams, patterns, etc that you think can illustrate the chosen solution.
  - What literal objects represent your solution?
  - What metaphors apply to your solution?
  - What possible allusions can you make in design, art, architecture, literature, history, anthropology, economics, etc, to your solution?
  - What personal influences and interests would you like to combine with your solution?
- Present your research collection as a PDF slide show.
  - Include: drawdown solution selection, your words, your found aphorisms or quotes, and your image research.
  - The last page should be a bibliography of your sources.

ASSIGNED APRIL 6; FOR REVIEW APRIL 13

## Formal Experiment

An experimental, expressive graphic exploration that responds to and expands on your research. // Deliverables: 20 Collages

### 1. Based on your research and collecting from WK1, please create 20 experimental compositions

- Make 20 square collages using whatever tools work for you.
- Explore the form-making potential of the words, aphorisms, and images you have gathered by manipulating type and image.
- Consider both analog and digital manipulation of letterforms and images.
  - How does the meaning of words change if you use a different typeface?
  - How do the compositions communicate your specific interpretation of the topic?
  - How can you use type and image to communicate spatial relationships and environments? Consider shadow, plane, perspective, overlay and depth.

- Go wild with experimentation! What you can do to alter an image or typeface?
  - Abstract, make it modular, texturize, pattern, cut, tear, float, fold, frame, mask, project, adorn, alter...
  - These are not precious
  - Be un-selfconscious
  - work fast and try disparate directions.
- Present compositions

ASSIGNED APRIL 13; FOR REVIEW APRIL 20

## "Poster" Diptych

### 1. Create a poster diptych.

- Make two posters that express different aspects of your topic. The points of view can be complementary or contrasting.
  - Requirements:
    - Use a grid!
    - Poster must have 3 levels of hierarchy and include a heading
    - use at least 200 words of text and at least one image
- Build on your experimental compositions. Discover coincidences — both visual and language-based.
- Is there a composition that could be used as a grid for one or more of the posters?
  - Could you combine two or more of the compositions?
  - Have you discovered a certain technique that you want to replicate in the posters?
- The definition for what a "poster" is can be variable: a traditional poster? small? giant? a billboard? a building? a website? animation? a wind turbine? video? app? what is a poster for and how does a different medium or framework still do that?
- Speculate what materials or processes your poster should use
  - > is your topic direct air capture of carbon dioxide? what do we do with the resulting stored carbon so that it is sequestered? can it be used as a printing medium for a poster!? Think about the solution you've chosen from Drawdown, and how does that influence your understanding of what a poster is and how you should hypothetically make your poster.

ASSIGNED APRIL 20; FOR REVIEW APRIL 27

## Continue Diptychs

Continue making progress on your poster pair.

APRIL 27

## Critique

### 1. Posters due

- Present however necessary for your poster concepts.
- Turn in Final Documentation?
  - include all the materials you created over the course of this project.